

Here are 15 "How might we..." (HMW) statements that break down Blue Yonder's strategic objectives into actionable projects, pairing each with a concrete action and the primary Red Hat technology to drive the initiative:

1. HMW automate the migration of legacy JDA/RedPrairie workloads to the cloud without manual intervention?

- **Action:** Build an automated "Migration Factory" in collaboration with HCL to transition the 22% of Blue Yonder's customer base still running on legacy on-premise systems directly into Azure 1, 2.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat Ansible Automation Platform (AAP) and the Migration Toolkit for Virtualization (MTV).

2. HMW reduce the total cost of ownership (TCO) associated with the impending 2028 VMware contract renewals for 10,000-12,000 VMs?

- **Action:** Deploy a modern, Kubernetes-based Type 1 hypervisor to run legacy VMs side-by-side with containerized microservices, consolidating infrastructure and avoiding dual licensing costs during their cloud migration 3-5.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat OpenShift Virtualization.

3. HMW provide a secure, scalable foundation for Blue Yonder's "Ops Agents" to process over 20 billion AI predictions daily?

- **Action:** Implement an enterprise-grade AI orchestration layer to deploy, test, and securely govern the multi-model Generative AI agents that power the Blue Yonder Orchestrator 6, 7.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat OpenShift AI.

4. HMW ensure Blue Yonder Defense Solutions can operate reliably in disconnected, denied, intermittent, or limited (D-DIL) military environments?

- **Action:** Deploy and certify Blue Yonder supply chain software on rugged Panasonic TOUGHBOOKs, providing secure, military-grade edge computing for tactical deployments 8-10.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL) and Red Hat Device Edge.

5. HMW help HCL and Blue Yonder mitigate the security risks of unsupported, fragmented community AWX environments?

- **Action:** Execute a phased migration from community AWX (which was refactored into microservices and no longer receives centralized CVE patches) to a fully supported, secure enterprise automation standard 11, 12.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat Ansible Automation Platform (AAP).

6. HMW drastically reduce the Mean Time to Recovery (MTTR) for unplanned outages across Blue Yonder's 30,000 managed servers?

- **Action:** Create an "auto-healing" infrastructure that integrates system observability tools to automatically trigger remediation playbooks upon detecting network anomalies or ransomware threats 11, 13, 14.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Event-Driven Ansible (EDA).

7. HMW guarantee cryptographic integrity and secure data sharing across the newly acquired One Network ecosystem of 150,000+ trading partners?

- **Action:** Implement a secure software factory to automatically sign artifacts and centralize Software Bills of Materials (SBOMs), proving code provenance to comply with stringent new regulations like the EU Cyber Resilience Act 15-17.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat Trusted Software Supply Chain (Trusted Artifact Signer).

8. HMW eliminate configuration drift and simplify the patching of thousands of diverse Linux VMs?

- **Action:** Transition HCL and Blue Yonder infrastructure teams to an image-based OS management workflow, allowing them to build, deploy, and roll back the operating system exactly like a container image 18, 19.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** RHEL 10 Image Mode.

9. HMW prevent developers from accumulating technical debt when integrating the diverse codebases of acquired companies like Flexis and Doddle?

- **Action:** Integrate predictive analytics at build time to alert engineers to deprecated packages, upcoming lifecycle changes, or potential integration pitfalls before software reaches production 20, 21.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat Insights Deployment Planner.

10. HMW empower non-Linux savvy developers to quickly configure environments without bottlenecking the lean IT infrastructure team?

- **Action:** Provide developers with a generative AI command-line assistant to answer natural language questions about OS configuration, troubleshooting, and Podman container builds 22, 23.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Real Lightspeed for RHEL.

11. HMW maximize Blue Yonder's massive \$1 billion commitment to Microsoft Azure while maintaining hybrid cloud flexibility?

- **Action:** Launch a managed container application platform directly on Azure, allowing the IT team to shift operational overhead to Red Hat and Microsoft while burning down their Azure spend commitment 4, 24, 25.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Microsoft Azure Red Hat OpenShift (ARO).

12. HMW process localized IoT sensor data in real-time for reverse logistics and pharmaceutical cold-chain tracking?

- **Action:** Deploy localized compute nodes at cross-dock facilities and warehouses to process IoT telemetry (e.g., temperature, humidity) on-site, cutting cloud egress costs and enabling sub-100ms autonomous robotic responses 26, 27.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat OpenShift (Edge deployments).

13. HMW accelerate the deployment of the new Cognitive Suite by reducing the time developers spend writing automation code?

- **Action:** Embed AI-assisted coding tools into the developer workflow to automatically generate high-quality Infrastructure-as-Code (IaC) and automation playbooks using natural language prompts 28.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Ansible Lightspeed.

14. HMW enhance AI model transparency to meet enterprise and governmental governance standards?

- **Action:** Establish a cryptographic registry for Artificial Intelligence Bills of Materials (AIBOMs) to verify the training data, provenance, and dependencies of the machine learning models used in Blue Yonder's Ops Agents 7, 29.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat Trusted Profile Analyzer.

15. HMW reduce latency and maximize throughput for real-time messaging systems handling peak e-commerce delivery loads?

- **Action:** Containerize and orchestrate high-throughput middleware (such as Kafka and Redis Enterprise) to ensure elastic scalability and sub-second communication across the multi-enterprise network during peak retail seasons 5, 30.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat OpenShift Container Platform.